First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Monday: 2pm-4pm; Tuesday 8am-2pm; Wednesday 9am-Noon; Thursday 8am-2pm; Friday 10am-Noon.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: Tues. & Wed, 9am-12pm, and by appt.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Lane McElree

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

November 5, 2023

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

All Saints Sunday November 5, 2023

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words**:**
"Be careful not to mistake insecurity and inadequacy for humility! Humility has nothing to do with the insecure and inadequate! Just like arrogance has nothing to do with greatness!" — C. JoyBell C.

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *If Thou but Suffer God to Guide Thee*

Welcome and Announcements

Sung Call To Worship Come and Fill Our Hearts (Taizé)

Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
You alone, O God, are holy.
Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
Al-le-lu--ia!

Call To Worship

All: Within this community

One: We experience God's unconditional love

All: Within this community

One: We rejoice in the risen Christ

All: Within this community

One: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

All: Within this community

One: We join together in worship

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Announcements Continued:

Women's Fellowship Breakfast
November 11 at 9am
Maple City Diner
Great food & great conversation!
RSVP Sue Brown (527-6336)

Mitten Tree:
We are currently collecting mittens and scarfs to be distributed to local organizations and schools, who will in turn distribute them to individuals for the upcoming cold weather. Knitting instructions are available--just ask! Purchased items are also being accepted.

Open-Mic
November 18
7:00-9:00 pm
1st Year Anniversary!
Music, skits, dance, spoken word, jokes.
Everyone is welcome: from beginners to experts to everyone in between!

Concert Announcement: Next Sunday, November 12th at 3pm is the "Play Every Town VT" concert with pianist David Feurzeig and guest clarinettist Elisabeth LeBlanc. David plays a wide range of music, from Scarlatti to Ragtime!

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**
God our Teacher, please instruct us in the ways of humility and love. Help us to be in community with one another rather than in competition with each other. Give us your heart for serving our neighbor. Assure us of your abiding presence and release us from the hierarchies of this world. May your kin-dom come with power and gentleness in your name. Amen.

Hymn* ***"To You, O God, All Creatures Sing"*** (1, 2, 4) NCH 17

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Unison)**
O God, we struggle to trust you in all aspects of our lives, and we seek validation from temporal and inadequate sources. We confess that we base how we think of ourselves on human structures, plans, and schemes. We are not satisfied with the gifts and purpose you have given to us. We do not appreciate the ways in which we are uniquely and wonderfully made. Deliver us from the tyranny of comparison and renew a right spirit of humility and peace within us, we pray. Amen

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Invitation to Candle Lighting

Anthem *Blest are the pure in heart* Antony Baldwin

Scripture Readings

Matthew 23: 1-12

Morning Reflection

Do As I Say . . .

Hymn*

"Let Us Break Bread Together" NCH 330

THE COMMUNION

Blue Binder

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Choral Call To Prayer

Hear Our Prayer, O lord D. Welpton

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

Choral Response To Prayer

"*Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee.*"
Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"Precious Lord, Take My Hand" NCH 472

Benediction

Postlude *Neo-Baroque* S. Conrady

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

★ Sandy Cristman, Greg Beeman, Sue and Ray Brown, Connie and Bruce Rhodes, Stephen McLaughlin, Amanda Parrott, Marina Perron, Valerie Waldon, Tony Odrechowski, Paula Kane, Jo Ann Chambers, Nancy Holland, Mykala Prior Thank You for helping with Spooky Saturday! It was so much fun it was scary!

★ Stephan Conrady, Thank you for playing spooky and creepy music for Spooky Saturday's festivities!

Ride Volunteers

We are in search of volunteers to help provide rides. These rides consist of helping people get to and from church for services and events. If you would like to volunteer or are looking for a ride, please contact the office @ (802)524-4555 or email using: info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org.

Annual Meeting

November 12- after church

Zoom Bible Study

Our next Bible Study will meet on November 8
There will be no Bible Study November 22
Fellowship 6:45pm;
Bible Study 7:00- 8:00pm
Text: Matthew Matthew 25:1-13
You can join us at any time, call Pastor Jessica for the Zoom link

Music Notes:

The composer of today's anthem is currently Director of Music at the American Church of London, and organist to the Thomas Tallis Society and Chamber Choir in the UK. The text is from the All Saints Day lectionary Matthew 5:8 "Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God."